



Arm-based MacBook Air

Apple has announced 2020 MacBook Air, running on the Arm-based M1 processor. <https://digit.in/dec20-53>



Macbook Redesigned

Apple to release redesigned variants of the Macbook with Apple Silicon in 2021. <https://digit.in/dec20-54>

Dell XPS 13 9300

Still the thin and light king

The Dell XPS 13, over the years, hasn't seen much of a design change, with the last two versions being practically the same in terms of build and design. This year, however, Dell has really pushed the envelope of what thin and light can come to mean. Let's see how it fared in our review.

Build and design

The Dell XPS 13 this year looks distinctly different from its predecessors. The back of the laptop has an angular cut which accommodates the hinge. The overall thickness is lesser and frankly, when it's open, the laptop almost feels like you may be able to snap it. However, good luck doing that. Dell uses woven glass fibre for the white coloured variant and a solid single block of aluminium. When open, the keyboard island has no flex, even if you try to force-bend it. The Dell XPS 13 is a masterclass in how to build a premium laptop and there are no two ways about it.

Keyboard, Trackpad, and I/O

One of the most enjoyable things about the XPS 13 besides its display is the keyboard. The XPS 13 offers rather wide keycaps. All keycaps are generously sized, not just the letters. The keystrokes are short, but stiff, offering great feedback and a fast typing experience. The power button on the top right doubles up as a fingerprint sensor. This sensor works very fast and very well.

The trackpad on the XPS 13 is somewhat small, especially given that there are bigger ones on other machines like the MacBook Air. Despite the small-ish size, it's definitely very usable.

The one area where the XPS leaves room for complaint is the I/O. All you get are two Thunderbolt 3.0 ports on either side, along with a microSD card slot and a 3.5 mm headphone/microphone jack. One Thunderbolt 3.0 port



Price
₹2,29,800

gets used up when you have the charging cable plugged in and the other one will get taken up by whatever accessory you plug into it.

Performance

The Dell XPS 13 we have is the highest-end variant, packing an Intel Core i7-1065G7, 16GB DDR4 memory which is soldered onto the motherboard and a 1TB SK Hynix NVMe drive.

Our testing is divided into synthetic and real-world tests, which the Dell XPS 13 aces wonderfully. In terms of synthetic benchmarks, the XPS 13 comes ahead of the ZenBook 14 UX425 and the Lenovo Yoga C940. In real-world usage, the XPS 13 shines once again. Juggling between doc files, an Excel file with 5 million data points and a 1.2GB PPT file. At the same time, Firefox was running with a very liberal 28 tabs running in the background. At no point does the system slow down. Firing up an instance of Adobe Lightroom does cause some slowdown overall, but quitting out of PowerPoint and Excel helps alleviate the issue. During this time, regardless of whether the XPS 13 was running on battery or AC power, there was barely any warming of the keyboard.

Display

The Dell XPS 13 that we received comes equipped with a 4K panel. Dell has

gone 16:10 for the display, which gives an effective resolution of 3840x2400.

The display supports HDR10 and Dolby Vision content playback and as such, is capable of hitting peak brightness of up to 400nits.

Analysing the colour characteristics of the panel using an Xrite i1Display Pro, we conclude that the Dell XPS 13's panel is well-calibrated right out of the box. The panel is able to reproduce 100 per cent sRGB colour space and 89.8 percent of the DCI-P3 colour space accurately, making it great for

proofing colour-sensitive work, and watching HDR content.



BUILD AND DESIGN.....	93
FEATURES.....	93
PERFORMANCE.....	90
VALUE.....	91

Battery life

The XPS 13 lasted 8 hours and 22 minutes in our PCMark10 battery life test, which is significantly lower than the 12 hours or so that the Lenovo Yoga

C940 did. Dell's Power Management app offers a staggering number of options that not only extend the general battery life but also settings that will extend the physical life of your battery.

Verdict

The Dell XPS 13 is an incredibly slim laptop that packs quite an amount of power. With a 10th generation Intel Core i7 processor in tow along with 16GB DDR4 memory, 1TB SSD and of course a gorgeous display capable of playing back HDR10 and Dolby Vision-enabled content. The battery life on this thing is excellent and the number of utilities Dell packs in allow you to really make the best of it. While the Dell XPS 13 is definitely expensive, but you're paying for a laptop that's damn near perfect in form and function.

—Swapnil Mathur

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7-1065G7 | RAM: 16GB DDR4 | STORAGE: 1TB NVMe | DISPLAY: 4K IPS

CONTACT

DELL INDIA | PHONE: 1800-425-4046 | EMAIL: Contactform@www.dell.com | WEBSITE: www.dell.com